Microsoft Security

Sentinel & Defender Session July 2025

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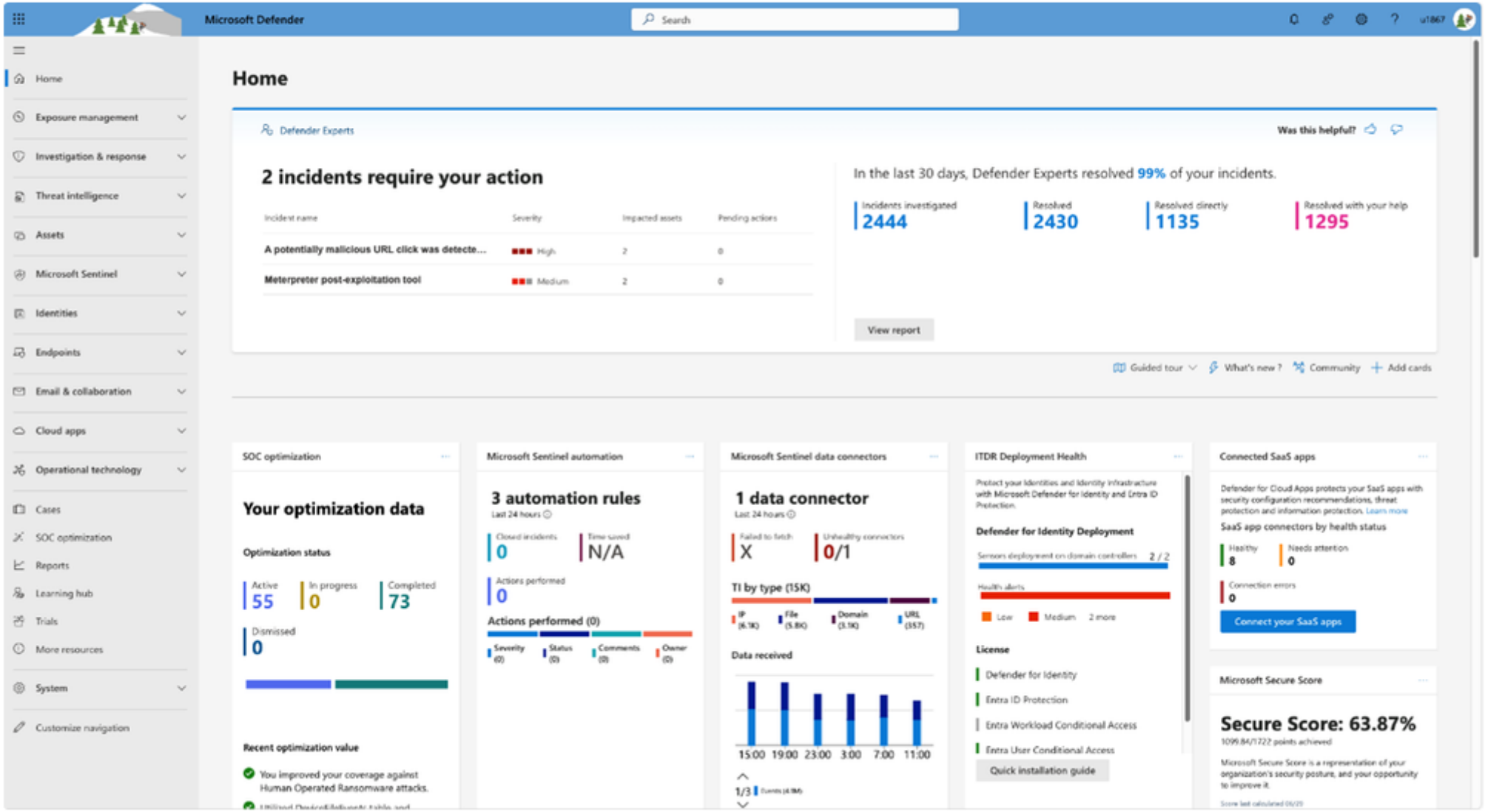
Microsoft Security

Sentinel moving to the DefenderXDR Portal

Today, we're announcing that we are moving to the next phase of the transition with a target to retire the Azure portal for Microsoft Sentinel by July 1, 2026. Customers not yet using the Defender portal should plan their transition accordingly.



Microsoft Sentinel in the Microsoft Defender portal

Microsoft Security Community Blog

MICROSOFT SECURITY COMMUNITY BLOG 5 MIN READ

Planning your move to Microsoft Defender portal for all Microsoft Sentinel customers

TomerBrand MICROSOFT
Jul 01, 2025

In November 2023, Microsoft announced our strategy to unify security operations by bringing the best of XDR and SIEM together. Our first step was bringing Microsoft Sentinel into the Microsoft Defender portal, giving teams a single, comprehensive view of incidents, reducing queue management,

Tips for a Successful Migration to Microsoft Defender

1. *Leverage Microsoft's help*:

Leverage Microsoft documentation, instructional videos, guidance, and in-product support to help you be successful. A good starting point is the documentation on Microsoft Learn.

2. *Plan early*:

Engage stakeholders early including SOC and IT Security leads, MSSPs, and compliance teams to align on timing, training and organizational needs. Make sure you have an actionable timeline and agreement in the organization around when you can prioritize this transition to ensure access to the full potential of the new experience.

3. *Prepare your environment:*

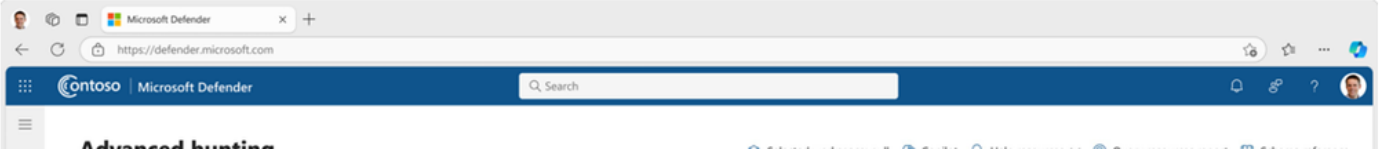
Plan and design your environment thoroughly. This includes understanding the prerequisites for onboarding Microsoft Sentinel workspaces, reviewing and deciding on access controls, and planning the architecture of your tenant and workspace. Proper planning will ensure a smooth transition and help avoid any disruptions to your security operations.

4. *Leverage Advanced Threat Detection:*

The Defender portal offers enhanced threat detection capabilities with advanced AI and machine learning for Microsoft Sentinel. Make sure to leverage these features for faster and more accurate threat detection and response. This will help you identify and address critical threats promptly, improving your overall security posture.

5. *Utilize Unified Hunting and Incident Management:*

Take advantage of the enhanced hunting, incident, and investigation capabilities in Microsoft Defender. This provides a comprehensive view for more efficient threat detection and response. By consolidating all security incidents, alerts, and investigations into a single unified interface, you can streamline your operations and improve efficiency.



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Detect threats
Uncover adversaries with threat intel
Hunt for threats
Investigate incidents
Respond to threats
Optimize your security operations
Manage your unified SOC
Resources
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Connect Microsoft Sentinel to the Microsoft Defender portal

05/26/2025 • Applies to: Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Sentinel in the Microsoft Defender portal

Microsoft Sentinel is generally available in the Microsoft Defender portal, with or without Microsoft Defender XDR or an E5 license. When you onboard Microsoft Sentinel to the Defender portal together Microsoft Defender XDR, you unify capabilities like incident management and advanced hunting. Reduce tool switching and build a more context-focused investigation that expedites incident response and stops breaches faster. For more information, see:

- What are unified security operations?
- Microsoft Sentinel in the Microsoft Defender portal
- Microsoft Defender XDR integration with Microsoft Sentinel

Prerequisites

Before you begin, review the feature documentation to understand the product changes and limitations.

- Microsoft Sentinel in the Microsoft Defender portal
- Advanced hunting in the Microsoft Defender portal
- Alerts, incidents, and correlation in Microsoft Defender XDR
- Microsoft Sentinel automation in the Defender portal

The Microsoft Defender portal supports a single Microsoft Entra tenant and the connection to a primary workspace and multiple secondary workspaces. If you have only one workspace when you onboard Microsoft Sentinel, that workspace is designated as the primary workspace. For more information, see Multiple Microsoft Sentinel workspaces in the Defender portal. In the context of this article, a workspace is a Log Analytics workspace with Microsoft Sentinel enabled.

In this article

Prerequisites
Onboard Microsoft Sentinel
Explore Microsoft Sentinel features in the Defender portal
Change the primary workspace
Offboard Microsoft Sentinel
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- Hunt for threats
- Investigate incidents
- Respond to threats
- Optimize your security operations
- Manage your unified SOC
- Resources

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Unified security operations with Microsoft Defender

Bring together the full capabilities of Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Security Exposure Management, and generative AI into the Microsoft Defender portal.

About unified security operations in the Defender portal

OVERVIEW

What are unified security operations

Microsoft Defender portal overview

WHAT'S NEW

What's new for unified security operations in the Defender portal

Get started

DEPLOY

Plan your deployment

Deploy for unified security operations

OVERVIEW

Zero Trust with unified security operations

Prevent, detect, and hunt for threats

CONCEPT

Security posture management and risk reduction

Detecting threats

Hunting for threats

Advanced hunting

Investigate and respond

CONCEPT

Incidents and alerts

Alert correlation and incident merging

Microsoft Copilot in Microsoft Defender

Automatic attack disruption

Optimize and manage security operations

CONCEPT

Optimize your SOC

Manage multiple tenants

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Delete out-of-the-box content
Manage solution deprecation lifecycle
Solution catalog
Manage content as code using repositories
Protect business applications
Integrate Microsoft Defender for IoT
Integrate Microsoft Defender XDR
Integrate Microsoft Defender for Cloud
Collect data
Integrate threat intelligence
Detect threats and analyze data
Hunt for threats
Investigate incidents

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Microsoft Defender XDR integration with Microsoft Sentinel

06/17/2025 • Applies to: Microsoft Sentinel with Defender XDR in the Microsoft Defender portal, Microsoft Sentinel in the Azure portal

Integrate Microsoft Defender XDR with Microsoft Sentinel to stream all Defender XDR incidents and advanced hunting events into Microsoft Sentinel and keep the incidents and events synchronized between the Azure and Microsoft Defender portals. Incidents from Defender XDR include all associated alerts, entities, and relevant information, providing you with enough context to perform triage and preliminary investigation in Microsoft Sentinel. Once in Microsoft Sentinel, incidents remain bi-directionally synced with Defender XDR, allowing you to take advantage of the benefits of both portals in your incident investigation.

Alternatively, onboard Microsoft Sentinel to the Defender portal to use it together with Defender XDR for unified security operations. For more information, see the following resources:

- What are unified security operations?
- Microsoft Sentinel in the Microsoft Defender portal

Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR

Use one of the following methods to integrate Microsoft Sentinel with Microsoft Defender XDR services:

- Ingest Microsoft Defender XDR service data into Microsoft Sentinel and view Microsoft Sentinel data in the Azure portal. Enable the Defender XDR connector in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Integrate Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR directly in the Microsoft Defender portal. In this case, view Microsoft Sentinel data directly with the rest of your Defender incidents, alerts, vulnerabilities, and other security data. To do this, you must onboard Microsoft Sentinel to the Defender portal.

Select the appropriate tab to see what the Microsoft Sentinel integration with Defender XDR looks like depending on which integration method you use.

In this article

Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR
Incident correlation and alerts
Common use cases and scenarios
Connecting to Microsoft Defender XDR
Working with Microsoft Defender XDR incidents in Microsoft Sentinel and bi-directional sync
Advanced hunting event collection
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Microsoft Sentinel is now in Defender

by Microsoft Security

Playlist · 11 videos · 965 views

Microsoft Sentinel is now fully integrated into the Microsoft Defender portal. You now get a single, pr ...more

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1

Onboarding a Microsoft Sentinel workspace into Microsoft Defender

Microsoft Security • 830 views • 1 month ago

2

Managing connectors in Defender

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Discover and manage Microsoft Sentinel content and threat intelligence in Microsoft Defender

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Creating Microsoft Sentinel automations and workbooks in Microsoft Defender

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Incident investigation in Microsoft Defender

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Advanced Hunting in Defender

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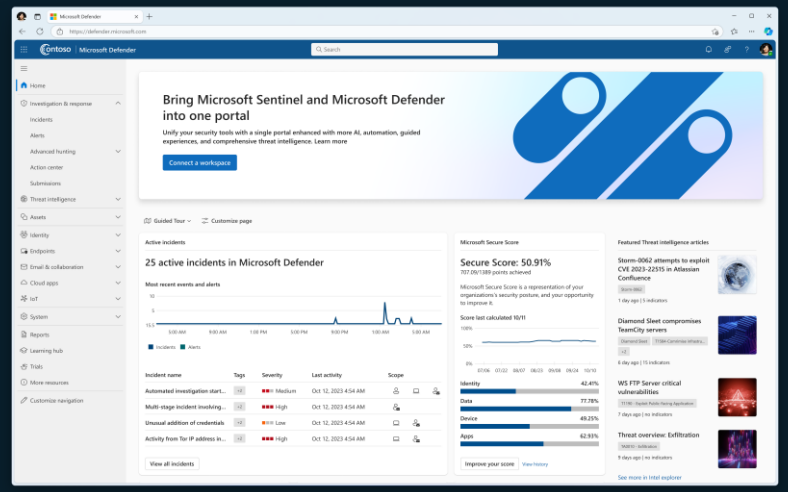
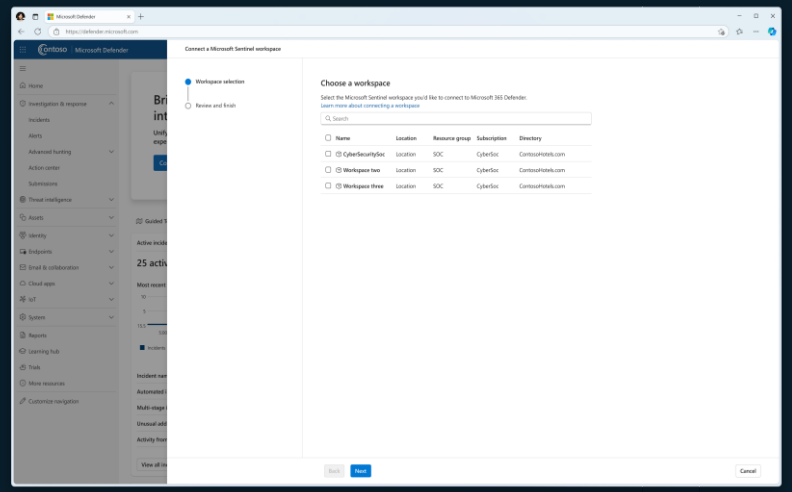
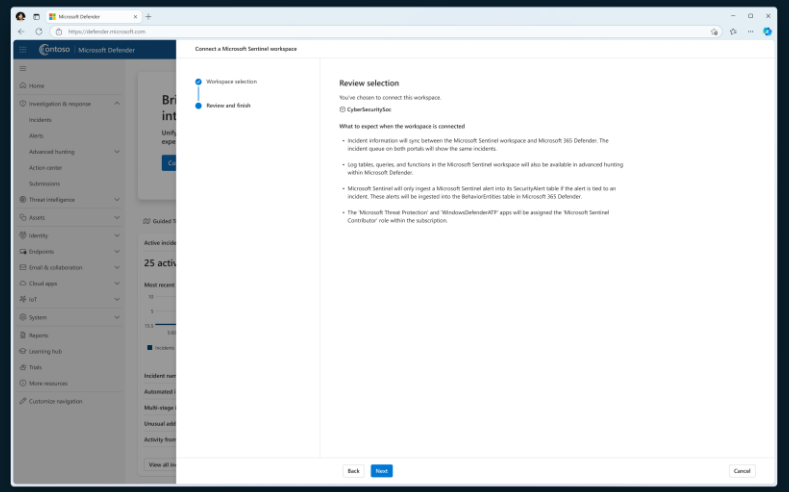
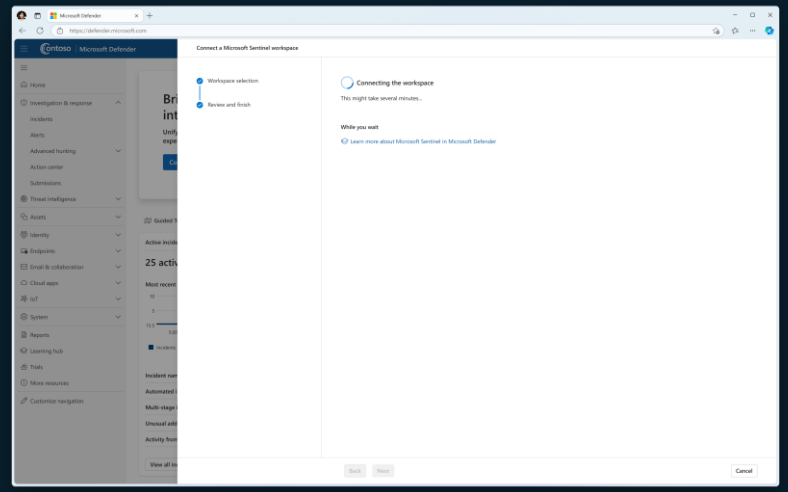
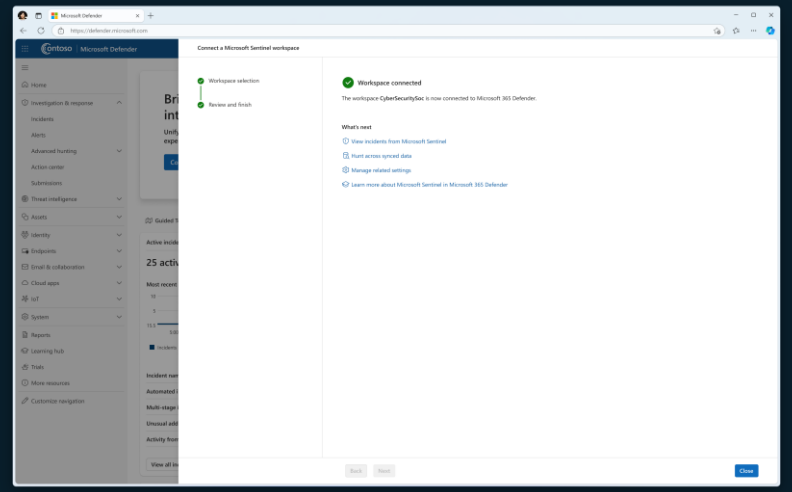
Onboarding a Microsoft Sentinel workspace is easy

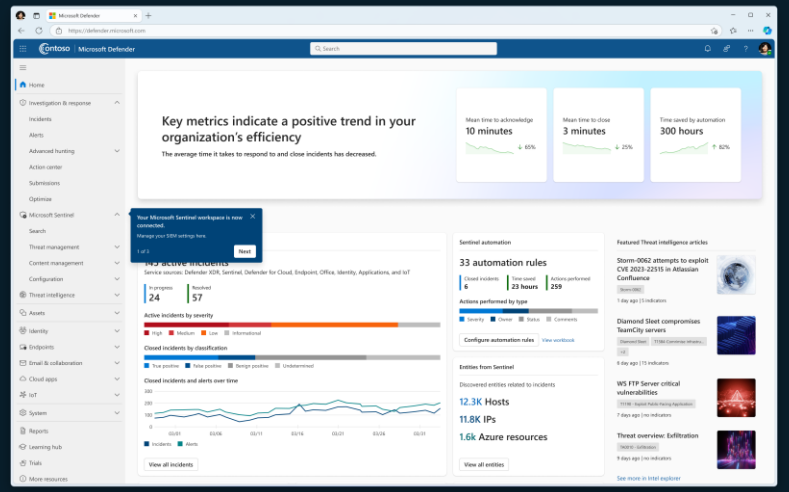












New July 22 Announcements

News • July 22 • 6 min read

Microsoft Sentinel data lake: Unify signals, cut costs, and power agentic AI

By Scott Woodgate and Krishna Kumar Parthasarathy

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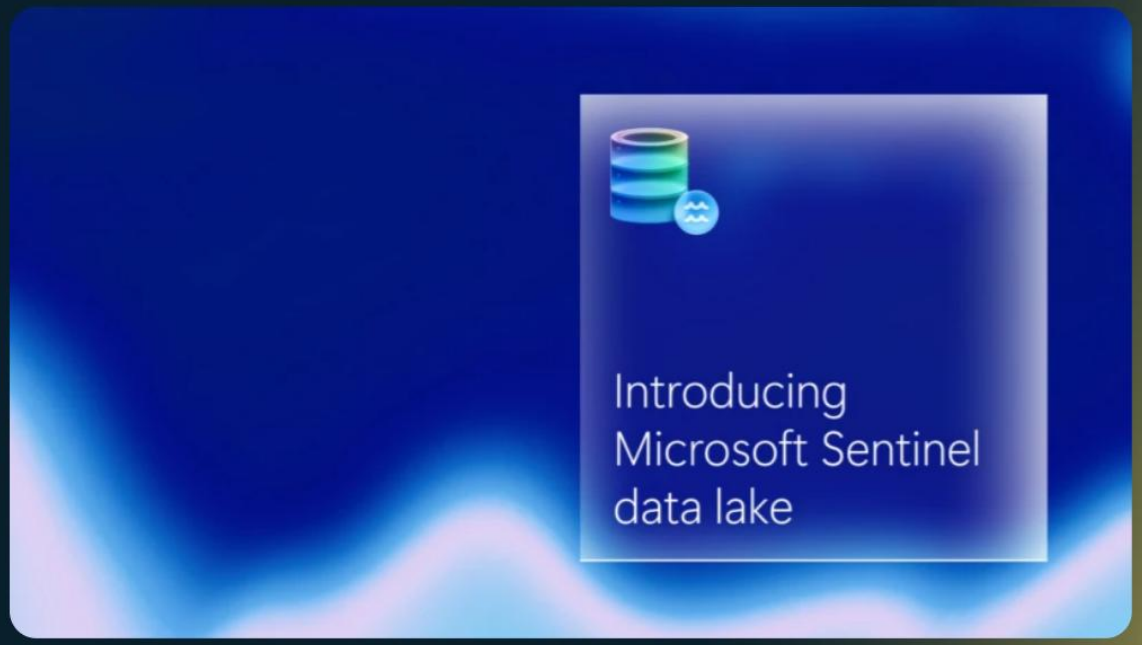

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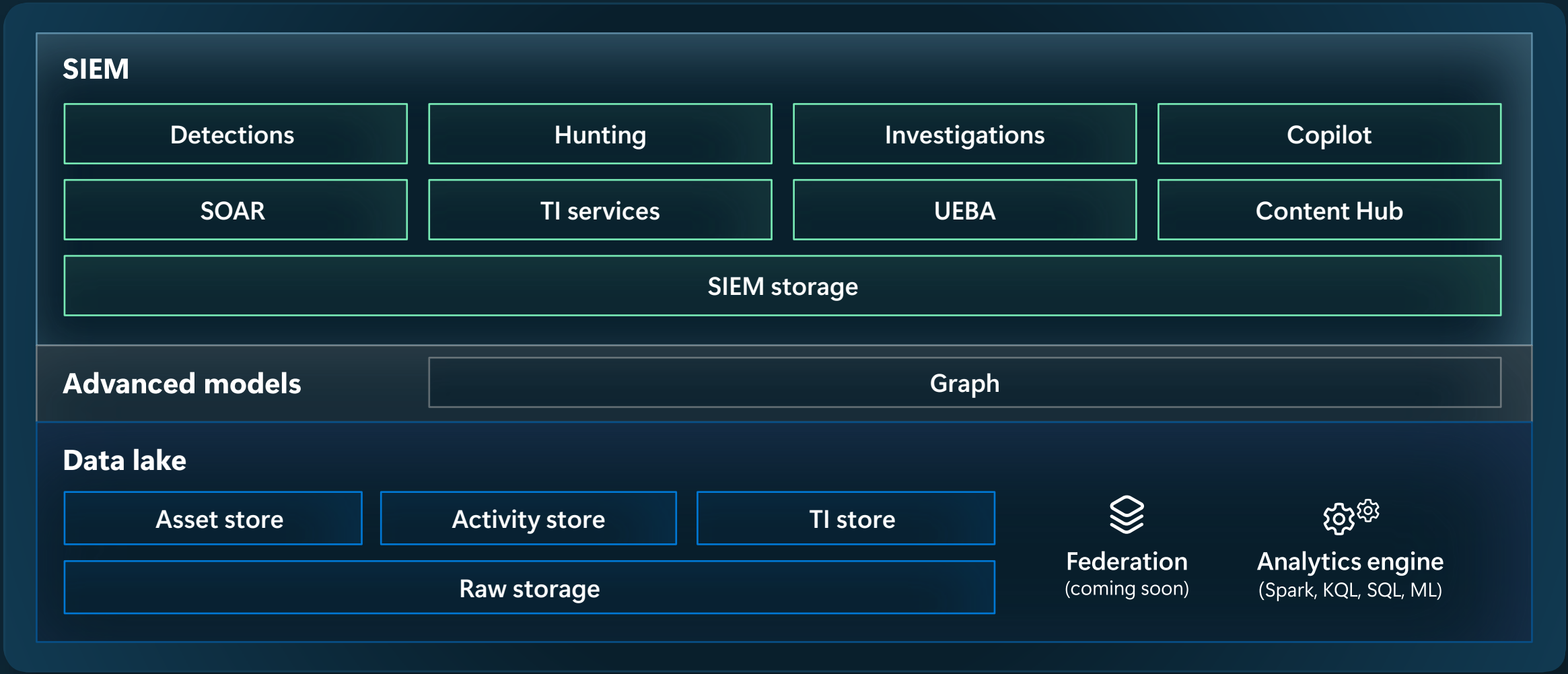
CONTENT TYPES

News

You can't protect what you can't see. Security operations teams have long been faced with the challenge of managing massive, fast-growing datasets, and the cost of scaling traditional data management tools to handle these data volumes has become unsustainable. We're evolving our industry-leading Security Incidents and Event Management solution (SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel, to include a modern, cost-effective data lake. By unifying all your security data, Microsoft

Microsoft Sentinel with security data lake architecture



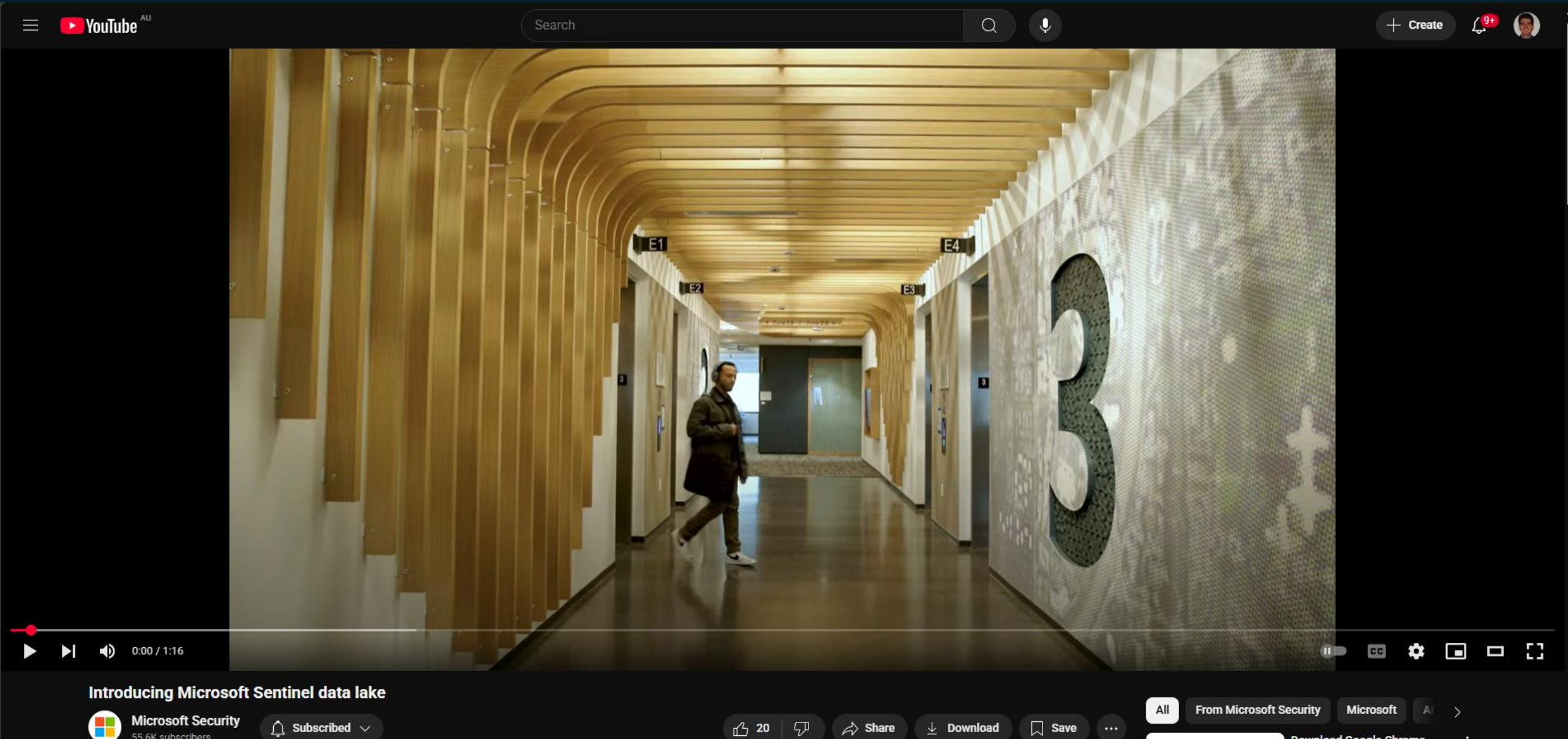
Note: This content is covered under NDA. Delivery timelines are subject to change.

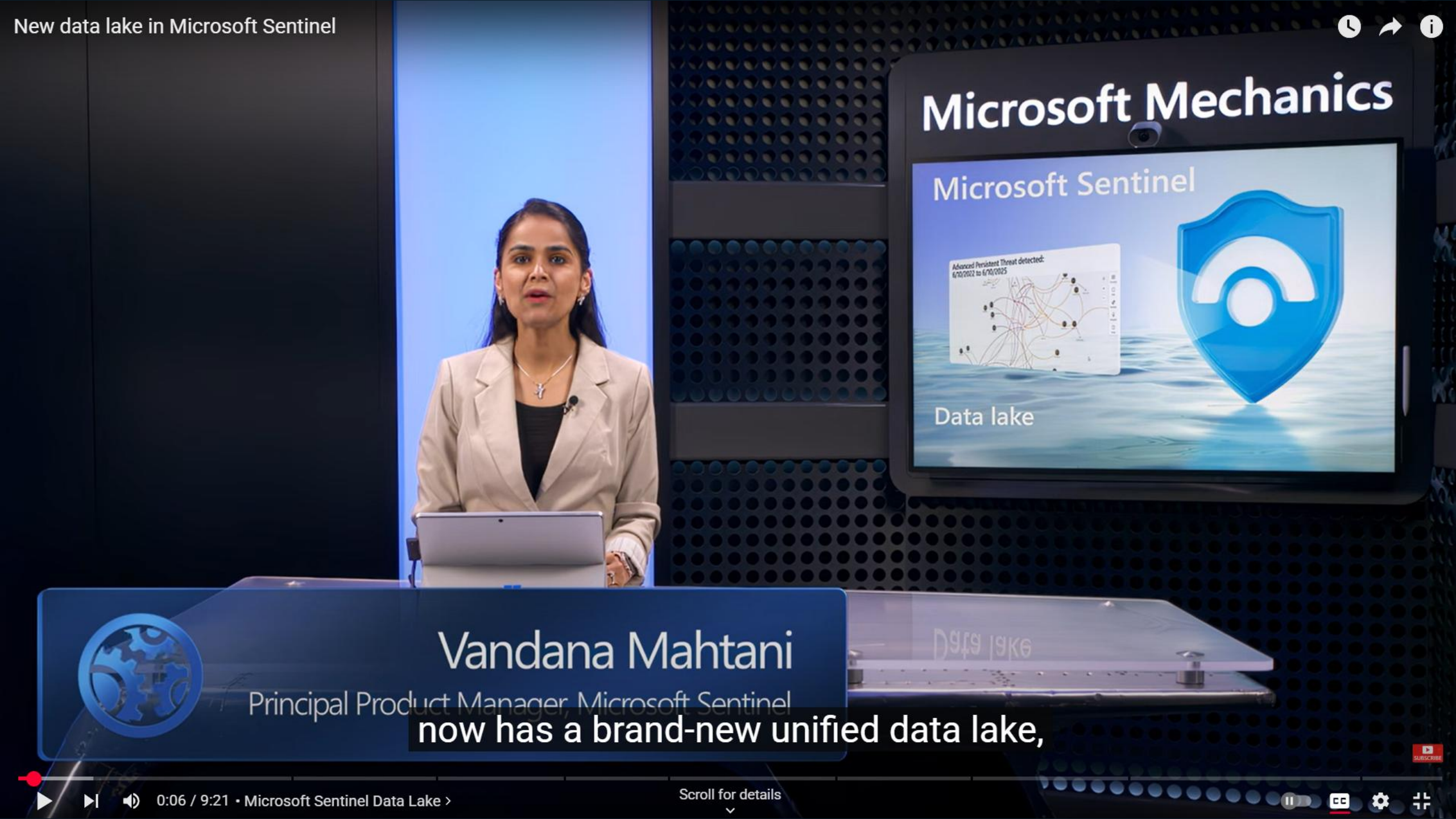
Capabilities available @ Public Preview

Name	Description
Streamlined onboarding experience	Get up and running with Sentinel data lake, fast and hassle-free.
Automatic data mirroring to data lake	Mirror Analytics tier data into the Sentinel data lake using existing data connectors, always current, always ready with no additional cost.
Data lake first ingestion	Ingest data directly into Sentinel data lake using existing connectors for scalable, cost-effective storage and flexible analytics with KQL or Spark.
Unified asset intelligence for threat and posture insights	Make digital asset data such as identity, device, service, and app data, readily available in the Sentinel data lake, continuously updated to power SecOps workflows.
Advanced KQL querying	Powerful KQL queries and jobs (for long running, high volume queries) on the data in the data lake for deeper security insights and automation.
Deep security insights with Spark-based notebooks	Analyse threats at scale for deep security insights using Jupyter notebooks backed by built-in Spark compute.
Comprehensive table management	Table management experience for managing tables and connectors, gives full control over their data pipelines.
Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)	Security and governance with fine-grained, role-based access, ensures the right people have the right level of access.
Transparent Cost Management	Cost visibility and optimization tools to help manage spend and maximize ROI.

Note: This content is covered under NDA. Delivery timelines are subject to change.

Brief Sentinel Data Lake introduction




New data lake in Microsoft Sentinel
Microsoft Mechanics
Microsoft Sentinel
Data lake
Vandana Mahtani
Principal Product Manager, Microsoft Sentinel
now has a brand-new unified data lake,
0:06 / 9:21 • Microsoft Sentinel Data Lake
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Sentinel Data Lake - Overview

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- Migrate
- Manage solutions and content
- Collect data
- Manage data
- Integrate threat intelligence
- Detect threats and analyze data
- Hunt for threats
- Investigate incidents

What is Microsoft Sentinel data lake (preview)?

07/22/2025

Microsoft Sentinel data lake is a purpose-built, cloud-native security data lake that transforms how organizations manage and analyze security data. Architected as a true data lake, it is designed to ingest, store, and analyze large volumes of diverse security data at scale. By centralizing all your security data into a single, open, and extensible platform, it delivers deep visibility, long-term retention, and advanced analytics.

The data lake makes it cost-effective to bring all your security data into Microsoft Sentinel, eliminating the need to choose between coverage and cost. Retain more data for longer, detect threats with greater context and historical depth, and respond faster, without compromising on security.

The Microsoft Sentinel data lake is fully managed, without the need to deploy or maintain your data infrastructure. It provides a unified data platform for end-to-end threat analysis and response. It enables you to store one copy of security data across assets, activity logs, and threat intelligence in the lake and leverage multiple analytics tools like KQL and notebooks for deep security analytics.

Traditional SIEM solutions struggle with the cost and complexity of storing and querying long-term data. Microsoft Sentinel data lake addresses these challenges in the following ways:

- Unifying security data across Microsoft Defender XDR, third-party sources and across assets, activity logs, and

In this article
- Architecture
- Supported regions
- Get started

Was this page helpful?
Yes | No

Microsoft Defender

Search

Set up Microsoft Sentinel data lake

Get cost-effective storage and the ability to query over all your data here in the Defender portal.

Get started

Secure score

Secure Score: 57.78%

871.3/1508 points achieved

Microsoft Secure Score is a representation of your organization's security posture, and your opportunity to improve it.

Score last calculated 06/04

100%

50%

06/07 06/13 06/19 06/25 07/01 07/07 07/13 07/19 07/25 07/31 08/06 08/12 08/18 08/24 08/30

Identity	88.16%
Data	33.33%
Device	49.04%
Apps	70.86%

Improve your score | View history

Threat analytics

264 threats require action

High-impact threats

Threat Insights: CVE-2021-4034 PwnKit local privilege...	27,391 / 35,166
Threat overview: Exfiltration	23,854 / 32,000

Active Alerts | Resolved Alerts | No Alerts

Highest exposure threats

Threat Insights: CVE-2022-41128 vulnerability in JScript9 engine	5
Actor profile: Twill Typhoon	3

High 70-100 | Medium 30-69 | Low 0-29

See more

Users at risk

190 users at risk

High Risk | Medium Risk | Low risk

View all users

Discovered devices onboard

20 devices lack protectio

Device onboarding status to Defender for Endpoint over tim

99.7%

99.6%

99.5%

09/05 09/07 09/09 09/11 09/13 09/15 09/17 09/19 09/21 09/23 09/25 09/27 09/29

Onboard devices

Set up Microsoft Sentinel data lake (preview)

60 min to complete

Get cost-effective storage and the ability to query over all your data.

Learn more about the data lake

Setup | Benefits and impact

Benefits

Built-in, flexible data tiers
Get versatile data storage options purpose-built for the needs of your SOC. Store critical data in the analytics tier for ongoing detections and SOAR, or seamlessly route raw or normalized data for long-term retention.

Query over historical data
Use KQL to query all data in the lake to hunt for attack vectors, IoCs, anomalies, and enable behavioral analysis and predictive modeling. Also, use Spark in the new Visual Studio Code extension.

Data from everywhere
Bring in data from across clouds, platforms, assets, tools, and domains with 350 plus native connectors. Or configure a custom connector in as little as 2 hours.

Centralized cost management
Track usage, estimate charges, onboard data, choose storage options, and adjust retention to manage and optimize costs for all your security data.

Impact

New billing meters
If an existing Microsoft Sentinel workspace uses search jobs, queries, auxiliary logs, or long-term retention (also known as 'archive'), billing and pricing for those features will switch to the Microsoft Sentinel data lake meters, potentially increasing your cost.

Asset data storage
Information about your Microsoft 365, Entra, and Azure assets will be stored in the data lake.

Set up data lake | Cancel

MICROSOFT SECURITY COMMUNITY BLOG 5 MIN READ

Introducing Microsoft Sentinel data lake

Abhishek_Agrawal MICROSOFT
Jul 22, 2025

Sentinel data lake, rolling out in Public Preview, giving security teams a powerful, cost-effective way to unify, retain, and analyze all security data. Built to eliminate data silos, simplify security data management, and deliver AI-ready data & analytics without having to manage complex infrastructure.

Microsoft Defender

Search

Threat management
- Workbooks
- Hunting
- Notebooks
- Threat intelligence
- MITRE ATT&CK

Content management
- Content hub
- Repositories
- Community

Configuration
- Tables
- Data connectors
- Analytics
- Summary rules
- Watchlist
- Automation

Data lake exploration
- KQL queries
- Jobs
- Search & restore

Identities

Endpoints

Email & collaboration

Tables

Number of tables	Analytics tier	Data lake tier	XDR default tier
11	11	0	0

Manage

Realize the full
and cost-effecti
Basic plan is no

Manage table

Type: Any | Tier: Any | Add filter

Table name	Tier	Table type	Analytics retenti
AWSVPCFlow	Analytics	Sentinel	180 days
AWSGuardDuty	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSCloudTrail	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSCloudWatch	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSWAF	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSSecurityHubFindings	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSRoute53Resolver	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSNetworkFirewallAlert	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSNetworkFirewallFlow	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSNetworkFirewallTls	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year
AWSS3ServerAccess	Analytics	Sentinel	1 year

Manage AWSCloudTrail

After you've set up Microsoft Sentinel data lake, all new data ingested into this table is automatically available in the data lake regardless of tier. To access archived data ingested prior to setup, use search and restore. Learn more about data retention

The following content will not be available for tables in lake tier : Analytics rules, Hunting query, Parsers, Playbooks, Watchlist and workbook . Any existing content will stop working after changing to lake tier. Learn more

Analytics tier

Analytics data supports real-time monitoring, detection, and hunting. To place data into longer-term storage that you can query, extend the total retention period.

Show Data retention settings

Data lake tier

The data lake provides cost-effective storage with support for flexible data formats, KQL queries, notebooks, and jobs.

Only data ingested after you've set up the data lake will be moved to this tier. To access archived data ingested prior to setup, use search and restore.

Retention *

12 years

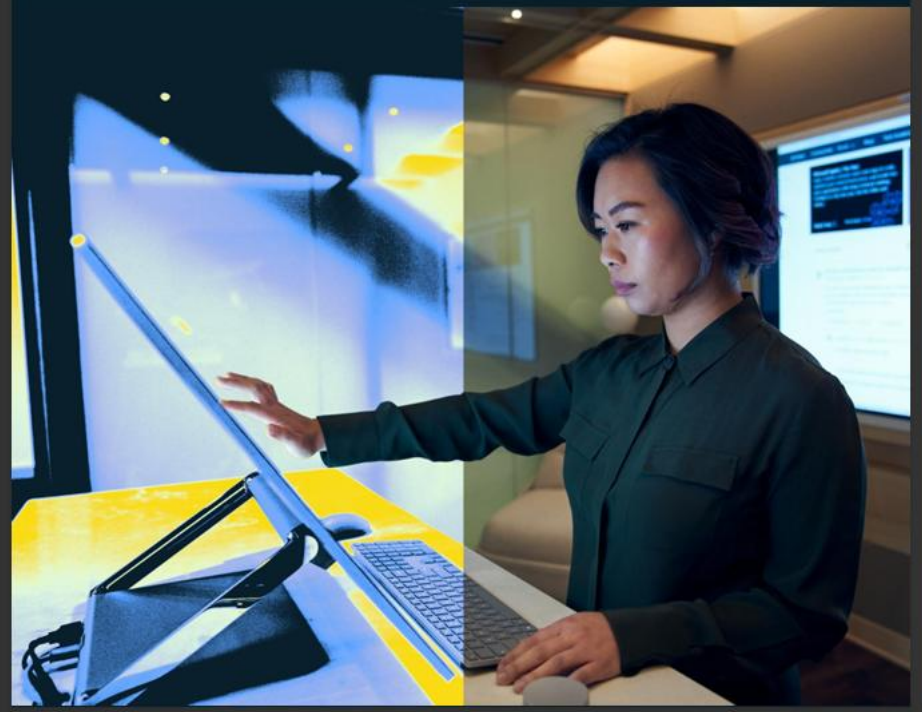
Hide Data retention settings

Adoption Guide (available for download)

Microsoft Security

A guide to adopt the Microsoft Sentinel data lake

July 2025



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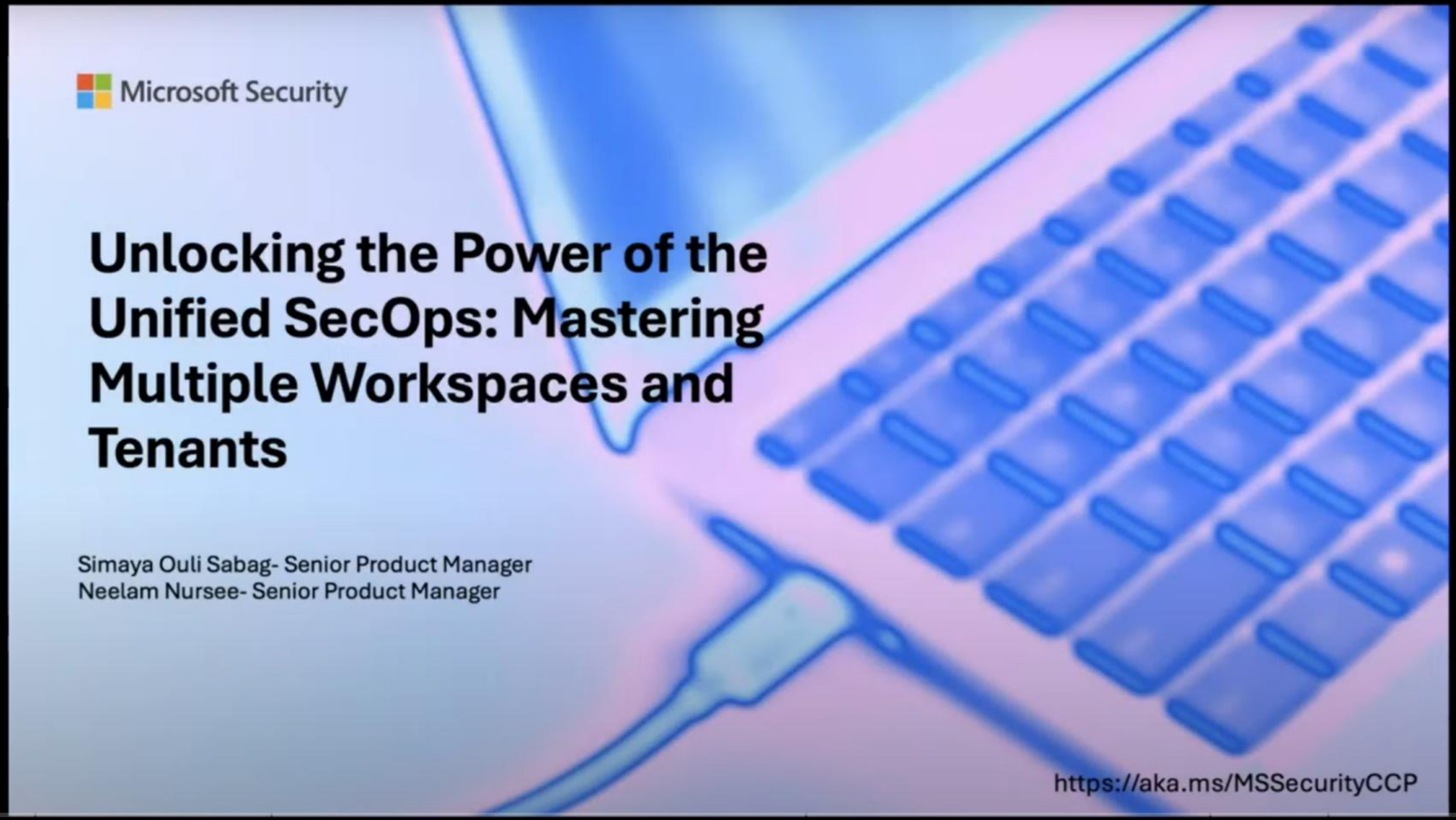
Unlocking the Power of the Unified SecOps: Mastering Multiple Workspaces and Tenants



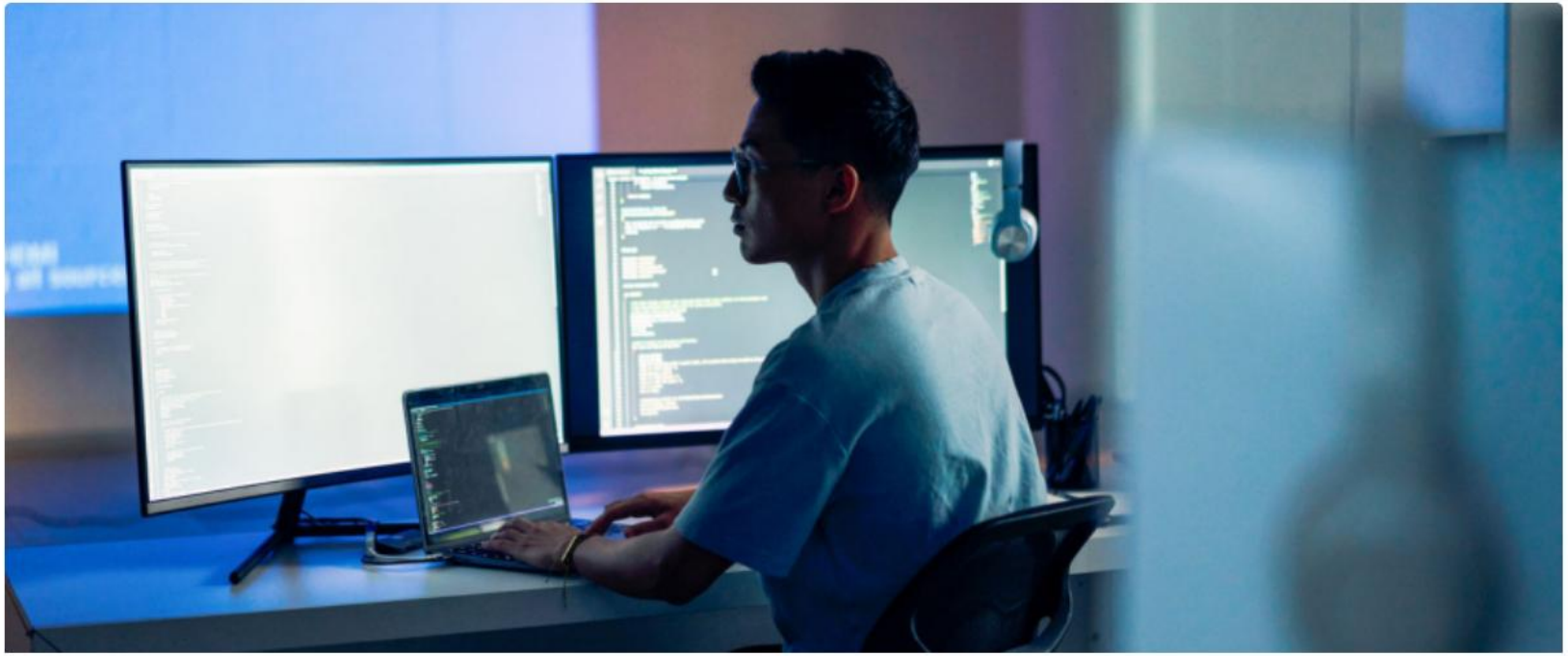
0:02 / 37:28 • Introduction ›

Scroll for details

Some links for more information

- Data Tiering
  - Microsoft Sentinel data lake overview (preview) - Microsoft Security | Microsoft Learn
  - Configure table settings in Microsoft Sentinel (preview) | Microsoft Learn
- Analysis
  - KQL and the Microsoft Sentinel data lake (preview) - Microsoft Security | Microsoft Learn
  - Exploring and interacting with lake data using Jupyter Notebooks (preview) - Microsoft Security | Microsoft Learn
- Further Detail
  - Microsoft Sentinel data lake: Transforming SIEM with AI and unified security data | Microsoft Security Blog
  - Introducing Microsoft Sentinel data lake | Microsoft Community Hub
  - Microsoft Sentinel data lake pricing (preview) | Microsoft Community Hub
  - Microsoft Sentinel data lake overview (preview) - Microsoft Security | Microsoft Learn

Defender Threat Intelligence at no additional cost



MICROSOFT DEFENDER THREAT INTELLIGENCE BLOG 4 MIN READ

MDTI is Converging into Microsoft Sentinel and Defender XDR

Mike_Browning MICROSOFT
Jul 22, 2025

The convergence of MDTI value will provide unified, real-time threat insights at no additional cost

In today's rapidly evolving threat landscape, organizations need threat intelligence (TI) that is woven seamlessly into every step of their security operations—delivered exactly when and where it matters most. That's why Microsoft is converging Microsoft Defender Threat Intelligence (MDTI) directly into Defender XDR and Microsoft Sentinel, which will provide world-class, real-time TI within a unified SecOps experience at no additional cost. This

Capability	Description	Defender Portal Feature	MDTI Feature	Sentinel	Defender XDR
Link TI to assets and endpoints	Automatically surface threat intelligence related to the organization's digital assets, vulnerabilities, endpoints, and alerts.	Threat Analytics (TA)	N/A		✅
Understand threat actors and tooling	Access a comprehensive library of threat intelligence, including OSINT, analysis of recent threat activity, and up-to-date Intel Profiles on threat actors that include threat tooling, actor tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs) and indicators of compromise (IoCs).	Finished Threat Intelligence (Threat Analytics Library)	Finished Threat Intelligence (Analyst Workbench)	✅	✅
Unmask adversaries	Pivot on unique internet data sets to correlate threat activity and uncover attacker infrastructure to enhance threat investigations (domains, IPs, hashes, and hosts) . Build organization-specific TI that enables proactive measures against threats.	Internet Data Sets (Unified TI Entities)	Internet Data sets (Analyst Workbench)	✅	✅
Rapidly Search Across TI	Easily search across all OSINT, internet data sets, detonation intelligence, and finished intelligence content.	Defender Search	Global Search	✅	✅
Enhance and expand Threat Hunting	Rapidly expand understanding of threats on the network by surfacing related threat actor-centric threat intelligence, IoCs, and powerful internet data sets that extend your knowledge of attacker infrastructure beyond what's on the network.	MDTI Sentinel Connector	MDTI Sentinel Connector	✅	Requires MDTI Sentinel Connector
Contextualize Threats	Automatically enrich incidents with related threat intelligence such as Intel Profiles to quickly contextualize threat activity.	MDTI Sentinel Connector	MDTI Sentinel Connector	✅	
Share TI and Collaborate	Collaborate and share threat intelligence, including IoCs, across teams within the organization.	Case Management	MDTI Projects	✅	
Detect Key Threats	Correlate threat actor IoCs with log data to identify and alert on emerging threats.	Sentinel Analytics Rule	Sentinel Analytics Rule	✅	
Respond to threats at scale	Build organization-specific TI at scale and automate key incident response motions such as threat investigations, alert triage, and threat blocking with Sentinel playbooks.	Sentinel Playbooks, TA API	Sentinel Playbooks, MDTI API	✅	
Integrate threat intelligence with third party products	Use IoCs and internet data sets in third party products via robust integrations	TA API	MDTI API	✅	

Thank You